THE FAMILY OF GOD · LESSON 1

The Father Who Never Gave Up

Romans 8:15 · Luke 15:11–32

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His love never stopped reaching.

> *"The Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship. And by him we cry, 'Abba, Father.'"*

Use these on your own or with a group. Read the passages, think it through, and write down what stands out.

1 How far would you go to convince someone that you love them? Think of an Old Testament story you know well — Noah, Abraham, the Exodus, David. What does it show you about the distance God was willing to go for His people?

2 A firefighter rescues a child from a burning house. What changes when the child is his own son or daughter? "God doesn't simply want to rescue us. He wants us home." Which picture of God have you lived with most: Rescuer, or Father?

3 Jefferson Fisher asks, “Is what I say what people hear?” Turn that question toward God. What has He been trying to say since He walked in the garden with Adam and Eve? What are you hearing? Where might you be mishearing Him, the way Israel so often did?

4 Read John 3:16, Romans 5:8, and Romans 8:15: God’s motivation, His demonstration, and His invitation. Which of the three is hardest for you to believe is meant for you personally? Why?

5 “A lighthouse doesn’t force anyone to come home. It simply keeps shining so they can find their way back.” Is there someone you love who has wandered — from you, from God, or both? What would keeping the door open for them look like this week?

6 Read Luke 15:11–24 and Romans 8:15–16. The son came home looking for a place to work; the father welcomed him back as a son. Do you relate to God more like a hired servant or a child? What would change if you truly believed you could cry out, “Abba, Father”?